

ROTHMANNIA

position in full light or partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained, neutral to acidic soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.

R. capensis, syn. *Gardenia capensis*, *G. rothmannia*. Evergreen, ovoid shrub or tree. H 20ft (6m) or more, S 10ft (3m) or more. Leaves are ovate, lustrous, and rich green. In summer, bears fragrant, tubular flowers, each with 5 arching, white to creamy-yellow petal lobes and a purple-dotted throat. Z10–12 (min. 45–50°F/7–10°C)

ROYSTONEA

Royal palm

ARECACEAE/PALMAE

Genus of evergreen palms, grown for their majestic appearance. Produces racemes of insignificant flowers in summer. Frost tender. Needs full light or partial shade and fertile, well-drained but moisture-retentive soil. Water potted plants freely in full growth, less at other times, especially when temperatures are low. Propagate by seed in spring at not less than 81°F (27°C). Red spider mite may be a problem.

R. regia (Cuban royal palm). Evergreen palm with an upright stem, sometimes thickened about the middle. H to 80ft (25m), S to 30ft (10m). Leaves are feather-shaped, 10ft (3m) long, upright at first, then becoming arching and pendent, and are divided into narrowly oblong, leathery, bright green leaflets. Z12 (min. 59°F/ 15°C)

RUBUS

Blackberry, Bramble

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous, semievergreen or evergreen shrubs and woody-stemmed, scrambling climbers. Some species are cultivated solely for their edible fruits, which include raspberries and blackberries. Those described here are grown mainly for their foliage, flowers, or ornamental, often prickly stems, though some may also bear edible fruits. Fully to frost hardy. Deciduous species grown for their winter stems prefer full sun; other deciduous species need sun or partial shade; evergreens and semievergreens tolerate sun or shade. All require fertile, well-drained soil. Cut old stems of *R. biflorus*, *R. cockburnianus* and *R. thibetanus* to ground after fruiting. Propagate by seed or cuttings (semiripe for evergreens, softwood or hardwood for deciduous species) in summer or winter. *R. odoratus* may be increased by division, and *R. ‘Benenden’* and *R. ulmifolius ‘Bellidiflorus’* by layering in spring.

R. bambusarum, syn. *R.b. henryi* var. *bambusarum*. Fast-growing, vigorous, evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climber, grown mainly for its attractive foliage. H to 20ft (6m). Leaves have 3 broadly ovate leaflets, white-felted beneath. Tiny, pink flowers are borne in small clusters in summer. Z6–10

R. ‘Benenden’, syn. *R. ‘Tridel’*, illus. p.128.

R. biflorus illus. p.143.

R. cockburnianus. Deciduous, arching shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Prickly shoots are brilliant blue-white in winter. Dark

green leaves, white beneath, each have usually 9 ovate leaflets. Bears panicles of 5-petaled, purple flowers in early summer, followed by unpalatable, spherical, black fruits. Z3–8. **‘Goldenvale’** (syn. *R.c. ‘Wyego’*), H and S 5ft (1.5m), is less invasive, lower growing with more arching growth, and bright yellow foliage. **‘Wyego’** see *R.c. ‘Goldenvale’*.

R. odoratus (Flowering raspberry, Thimbleberry). Vigorous, deciduous, upright, thicket-forming shrub. H and S 8ft (2.5m). Prickle-free, peeling shoots produce large, velvety, dark green leaves, each with 5 broadly triangular lobes. From early summer to early fall, bears large, fragrant, 5-petaled, rose-pink flowers, sometimes followed by unpalatable, flattened, red fruits. Z3–8 **R. thibetanus** illus. p.143.

R. tricolor. Evergreen shrub with both prostrate and arching shoots covered in red bristles. H 2ft (60cm), S indefinite. Ovate, toothed, glossy, dark green leaves set off cup-shaped, 5-petaled, white flowers borne in midsummer. Has edible, raspberrylike, red fruits. Provides good groundcover. Z7–9 **R. ‘Tridel’**. See *R. ‘Benenden’*.

R. ulmifolius ‘Bellidiflorus’. Vigorous, deciduous or semievergreen, arching shrub. H 8ft (2.5m), S 12ft (4m). Prickly stems bear dark green leaves, with 3 or 5 ovate leaflets, and, in mid- to late summer, large panicles of daisylike, double, pink flowers. Z6–9

RUDBECKIA

Coneflower

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, and perennials grown for their flowers. Fully hardy to half hardy. Thrives in sun or shade and well-drained or moist soil. Propagate by division in spring or by seed in fall or spring.

R. fulgida (Black-eyed Susan). **var. deamii** (illus. p.251) is an erect perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm) or more. In late summer and fall, bears daisylike, yellow flower heads with central, black cones. Has narrowly lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. Prefers moist soil.

var. speciosa (illus. p.251) has elliptic to lance-shaped, almost sickle-shaped, basal leaves and coarsely toothed stem leaves. **var. sullivantii ‘Goldsturm’** (illus. p.251), H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm) or more, has golden flower heads. Z5–7

R. ‘Goldquelle’. See *R. laciniata ‘Goldquelle’*.

R. ‘Herbstsonne’ illus. p.251.

R. hirta. Moderately fast-growing, upright, branching, short-lived perennial, grown as an annual. H 1–3ft (30cm–1m, S 1–1½ft (30–45cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves and, in summer–fall, large, daisylike, deep yellow flower heads, with conical, purple centers. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Z9–11. **Becky Mixed**, H to 10in (25cm), has yellow, dark red or reddish brown flowers. **‘Goldilocks’** illus. p.325. **‘Irish Eyes’**, H to 2½ft (75cm), has yellow flower heads with olive-green centers. **‘Marmalade’** illus. p.323. **‘Rustic Dwarfs’**, H to 2ft (60cm), produces yellow, mahogany, or bronze flower heads. **‘Toto Gold’** illus. p.320.

R. laciniata ‘Golden Glow’. Erect perennial. H 6–7ft (2–2.2m), S 2–3ft (60cm–

1m). In late summer and fall, bears daisylike, double, golden-yellow flower heads with green centers. Mid-green leaves are divided into lance-shaped leaflets, themselves further cut. Prefers well-drained soil. Z4–9. **‘Goldquelle’** (syn. *R. ‘Goldquelle’*) illus. p.222. **‘Herbstsonne’** (illus. p.251) has single, bright yellow flower heads.

R. maxima (illus. p.251). Clump-forming perennial. H 6ft (2m) or more, S 2ft (60cm). Has broadly spoon-shaped, waxy, blue-green, basal leaves. In summer, stout stems bear solitary, dairylike, flower heads with slender, reflexed, yellow ray florets and large, central, black cones. Z5–9 **R. occidentalis**. Clump-forming perennial. H 2–6ft (60–180cm), S 1½ft (45cm) or more. Has ovate, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, erect, leafy, occasionally branched stems bear daisylike flower heads with a large, central, brownish-black cone surrounded by short, pointed, green bracts; they have no true ray florets (“petals”). Z5–9. **‘Green Wizard’** (illus. p.251), H to 6ft (2m), has a ring of large green bracts at the base of a dark brown central cone; ray-florets are absent. **R. purpurea**. See *Echinacea purpurea*. **R. triloba** (illus. p.251). Short-lived, upright, clump-forming perennial. H 32in (80cm), S 16in (40cm). Has 3-lobed, hairy, mid- to pale green, basal leaves. From late summer until fall frosts, leafy stems bear abundant, daisylike, bright yellow flower heads with central, blackish-brown cones. Self-seeds freely. Z4–8

RUELLIA

SYN. DIPTERACANTHUS

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of perennials and evergreen subshrubs and shrubs with showy flowers. Borderline fully hardy to frost tender. Grow in a humid atmosphere, partial shade, and in moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings or seed, if available, in spring. **R. amoena**. See *R. graecizans*.

R. devosiana illus. p.465.

R. graecizans, syn. *R. amoena*. Evergreen, bushy subshrub with wide-spreading stems. H and S 2ft (60cm) or more. Has ovate, pointed leaves and intermittently bears clusters of small, tubular, scarlet flowers. Z11–12 (min. 54°F/12°C)

R. makoyana (Trailing velvet plant). Hairy, spreading perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has ovate, silver-veined purple leaves, dark purple beneath. In summer, bears funnel-shaped, carmine-pink flowers singly from the leaf axils. Z11–12 (min. 54°F/12°C)

RUSCHIA

AIZOACEAE

Genus of mostly small, tufted, perennial succulents and evergreen shrubs with leaves united up to one-third of their lengths around stems or with very short sheaths. Frost tender. Needs a sunny site and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

R. acuminata. Evergreen, erect, succulent shrub. H 8in (20cm), S 20in (50cm). Has woody stems as well as non-woody, bluish-green stems with darker dots. Produces solid, 3-angled, 1¼in (3cm) long leaves, each with a blunt keel and a

short sheath. Daisylike, white to pale pink flowers, 1¼in (3cm) across, are borne in summer. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

R. crassa. Evergreen, erect, succulent shrub. H and S 20in (50cm). Bears solid, 3-angled, bluish-green leaves, ¾in (2cm) long, with short, white hairs; undersides are keeled, each with a single tooth. Bears daisylike, white flowers, 1in (2.5cm) across, in summer. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

R. macowanii. Erect, then spreading, shrubby, perennial succulent. H 8in (20cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has solid, slightly keeled, 3-angled, gray-green leaves, to 1¼in (3cm) long. In summer, bears abundant, daisylike, bright pink flowers, 1¼in (3cm) across, with darker pink stripes. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C)

RUSCUS

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of evergreen, clump-forming, spring-flowering shrubs, grown for their foliage and fruits. The apparent leaves are actually flattened shoots, on which flowers and fruits are borne. Usually, separate male and female plants are required for fruiting. Is particularly useful for dry, shady sites. Fully to frost hardy. Tolerates sun or shade and any soil other than waterlogged. Cut back dead shoots to base in spring. Propagate by division in spring. ☉The berries of *R. aculeatus* may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.

R. aculeatus (Butcher’s broom) illus. p.167. **‘John Redmond’** is an evergreen dwarf, compact shrub. H and S 1½ft (45cm). A hermaphrodite cultivar; it has spine-tipped, glossy, dark green “leaves,” tiny, star-shaped, green flowers in spring, and a profusion of round, orange-red berries from summer to winter. Z7–9 **R. hypoglossum** illus. p.167.

RUSSELIA

PLANTAGINACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous shrubs and subshrubs with showy flowers. Frost tender. Needs sun or partial shade. Requires humus-rich, light, well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings or division in spring.

R. equisetiformis, syn. *R. juncea* (Coral plant), illus. p.470.

R. juncea. See *R. equisetiformis*.

RUTA

Rue

RUTACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, summer-flowering subshrubs and woody-based perennials, with deeply divided, aromatic leaves, grown for their foliage and flowers and used as a medicinal herb. Fully to frost hardy. Requires a sunny position and well-drained soil. Cut back to old wood in spring to keep compact. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. ☉All parts may cause severe discomfort if eaten; the foliage may cause photodermatitis on contact.

R. graveolens (Common rue).

‘Jackman’s Blue’ illus. p.159.